Grammaticalization of nominal coordination

Anna Panova, HSE University, panova.anna.2004@gmail.com

In this talk, I summarize the results of my typological study of nominal coordination that is based on the data from 631 languages (198 families, 38 isolates, 6 macroareas). I considered factors such as the number of constructions for nominal coordination, other functions of the coordinator, the possibility of using the same coordinator for coordinating verb phrases and clauses, and the position of the coordinator in a construction with two conjuncts (following (Haspelmath 2007)).

I identify several types of coordinating constructions: coordinate, comitative, additive, number- and numeral-based (1–2), clausal (3–4), and other less frequent ones (5).

Ngarla (South-West Pama-Nyungan > Pama-Nyungan: Australia) (Westerlund 2015: 141, 105)

(1) jarrurn **piyalu** kunyjarta kumpungu ngayi-nyu-pula
man 3DU.NOM woman married INCH-PST-3DU
'The man and the woman got married.'

Yaminahua (Panoan > Pano-Tacanan: Bolivia, Brazil) (Loos 2002: 73, 98)

(2) Tome-**nõ**, poi-**nõ**, apa-**nõ** ik-a-fo pexe shara-fafãi
Tome-ASSOC brothers-ASSOC his.parents-ASSOC live-COMP-PL house good-CONT
'Tome, his brothers and parents live in a good house.'

Evenki (Northeastern Tungusic > Tungusic: Russia) (Nedjalkov 2014: 90)

(3) hekupchu-l tyrgani-l **taduk** inginipchu-l dolboni-l
hot-PL day-PL THEN cold-PL night
'Hot days and cold nights.'

Udi (Lezgic > Nakh-Daghestanian: Russia)

(4) bip: äjel, **sa.al** mac:i kürüχ q:ajnaq:o
four child AGAIN white braid mother.in.law
'Four children and an elderly mother-in-law.'

Creek (Creek > Muskogean: USA) (Martin 2011: 378–379)

(5) mo:m.ín sólk-i:t hokt-akí hopoy-ta:k-ocí **is-yô:m-a:t**
be.so many-DUR woman-PL child-PL-DIM INS-like.this-REF
ânławá.n foll-atí:-s
wilderness be.about.TPL-PST-IND
'Then many of them, women and children, wandered in the wilderness.'

Out of these, coordinate, comitative, and additive are by far the most frequent ones, at least one of them being found in almost all languages of the sample. Coordinate constructions involve a marker which is not recoverable on the synchronic level, which might suggest their rather early emergence. As coordinate constructions are the most commonly found type of coordinating constructions, it may imply that, contrary to frequently voiced opinion (see, among others, (Mithun 1988), (Mithun 1992), in many languages coordinating constructions could not have been grammaticalised only recently.

I tentatively propose several pathways of how nominal coordination can be grammaticalised (extending the typology of WITH- and AND-languages presented in (Stassen 2000): coordination as participant attachment, as participant grouping, and as an open set.

In the first pathway that I call participant attachment, coordination emerges from constructions in which one referent is introduced relative to another already established referent. It could be either the introduction of a discoursively secondary participant (via comitative, see (Arkhipov 2009) or a focal participant (via additive, 'THEN' (3) or 'AGAIN' (4) markers) that requires the presence of a discourse-accessible antecedent. The same conceptual mechanism of addition can apply to clausal contexts, allowing these markers to be used in clause-level coordination in about 50% of cases. In the second pathway, participant grouping, the coordinator scopes over all the conjuncts collectively. These constructions treat conjuncts collectively and equally as components of a single plural referential unit that would not arise in the absence of either participant. This pathway is represented by constructions involving markers of additive plurality, pronouns (1), numerals, and 'LIKE'-elements (5). These constructions are never found in clausal coordination; we argue that what prevents these markers from expanding into clausal coordination is that clauses, unlike noun phrases, cannot be conceived as a single referential unit. The third type involves markers of associative (2) and similative plurality which are applied to every conjunct individually. As these constructions are often prone to non-exhaustivity, presence of just one noun phrase marked with these markers is enough to define a set of participants and addition of other noun phrases would not fundamentally change the structure of the set.

Although the participant plurality pattern of grammaticalization could be viewed as more symmetric than the participant attachment one as both conjuncts equally depend on each other, constructions that originally encode asymmetry between the participants are attested in our sample more often (in 80 and 367 languages respectively).

This approach can also be applied in determining the diachronic syntactic structure of these constructions. Participant-attachment constructions originate from structures in which the marker is associated primarily with the second conjunct. At an earlier stage, they may have had the *[A] [B **co**]* structure, where the marker scopes over the newly introduced conjunct and not over a conjoined noun phrase as a whole, thus not forming a constituent. Participant-grouping constructions originate from *[A B] **co*** structures, where the conjuncts form a constituent-like unit. Associative and similative constructions do not operate over a closed conjoined structure, having the *[A] [B] **co*** structure, with both participants forming noun phrases of their own.

Abbreviations

AGAIN — coordinator of "AGAIN" type, ASSOC — associative plural, CONT — continuative, COMP — completive, DIM — diminutive, DU — dual, DUR — durative, INCH — inchoative, IND — indicative, INS — instrumental, NOM — nominative, PL — plural, PST — past tense, REF — referential clitic, THEN — coordinator of "THEN" type, TPL — triplural

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